Statement

Sensitive

Statement in the matter of R v Vida Reid

Name	Marisha Lombard
Occupation	Medical Receptionist
Address	Known to National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS)
Date	20 October 2022

STATES:

1. This statement made by me accurately sets out the evidence that I would be prepared, if necessary, to give in court as a witness.

2. My full name is Marisha Lombard and I am 58 years old.

3. On 2 June 2020, I filled in an Access Request Form (ARF) to apply for access to the National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS). In July and August 2020, I provided further evidence of my disabilities from my doctors; Dr Sam Takla and Dr Julie Fletcher (Clinical Psychologist) who diagnosed me with Rheumatoid Arthritis, Major Depression and General Anxiety Disorder.

4. On 12 August 2020. I was accepted as a participant of the NDIS and was given my NDIS number 431429651. My first plan was from 28 August 2020 to 6 April 2021 which was to the value of $49,967.91. My current NDIS plan is from 14 October 2022 to 13 October 2024 to the value of $188,991.51.

5. My understanding of the NDIS is to provide funding to pay for services in assisting me with everyday living and my safety.

6. A few months after my first plan had started, I needed a Support Co-Ordinator and I found it really difficult to organise any supports. I was looking up support workers and I found Ahmed's details in the phone book who currently has two companies,

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one is a not-for-profit organisation who provides support workers. After a few months using Ahmed's company as a support worker, Ahmed visited me to check how things were going and referred me to a lady called Vida for support coordination. Ahmed gave me her contact details and said Vida and Forward Focused Group (FFG) were really good, he said Vida used to work for the NDIS and could tell me what supports I could access.

7. On the same day Ahmed gave me Vida's number I called her straight away asking about Support Co-ordinators. In this conversation with Vida, she said she would arrange a time to come and visit me, that she has a child with a disability on the NDIS and she could help me with using my funding.

8. A few days later, Vida and another person who I don't remember came out to meet with me at my home. She explained again that she had worked for the NDIS and knew everything I would be eligible to receive supports for including things like a scooter, changes to my kitchen and she said it was her job to get me everything I was entitled to. She said she would organise the paperwork electronically so she can have permission with the NDIS to be able to coordinate services for me using my NDIS funding. Vida sent me a document to my email, during this meeting, for me to sign electronically, which I did on my phone. I know I signed a document giving Vida permission to go to NDIS on my behalf, but I cannot remember exactly what this document was. In this meeting Vida asked me if she could take a photo of me to put up in her office. I said to her yes, I would be okay with that. When I looked on the Facebook page for FFG I could see my photo all over Facebook which I did not give her permission to do.

9. After this meeting with Vida, the services I received were the Occupational Therapy, window and carpet cleaning and some gardening. When FFG contacted me my support coordinator changed frequently, and I received emails or calls from Blake, Janine Hall (Janine), Yasmine and an administrator named Kelly from FFG however I do not know who my support coordinator was supposed to be as it was always someone different who contacted me. The only time someone came to my house from FFG was when Vida came twice which was the first time and the second was when I told her I wasn't happy when Vida wanted $50,000 to start the home

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modifications I needed for my house. All other interactions with the support co-ordinators were over the phone.

10. I know Janine from FFG organised an Occupational Therapist to get me my bed and scooter through the NDIS. FFG also organised a physio to help me with exercises, but I only had the physio visit once a month.

11. At no stage did Vida from FFG provide the supports or services for any home modifications, there was only a couple of people coming out to do quotes. When Vida told me she wanted $50,000 to do these home modifications. I did not proceed with these home modifications based on the advice from my support worker Chloe, because she told me that is not how NDIS funding should work and I should not use my core budget to pay for home modifications if it is not included in my plan.

12. Sometime in September 2021, I was invited to some type of activity by FFG through an email where they sent it several times. I was unwell at this time and declined their invitation.

13. In about October 2021, I can remember Vida provided me with an opportunity to attend a Flower arrangement course, which I attended this one-day course for two hours. My support worker at the time Ahmed transported me to this one-day course.

14. In December 2021, I remember receiving an email inviting me to attend a New Years Eve Cruise where I responded to Vida and said yes, I would attend. Vida gave me the impression that this cruise is from her share of what she is charged, at no stage did she directly say this was going to be charged out of my NDIS funding. However, because of Covid I did not feel comfortable going, I decided not to attend this cruise. Vida told me that unfortunately it has been paid for already and it wouldn't be refunded and would come out of my NDIS funding.

15. In February 2022, I remember receiving an email and multiple phone calls from a Chinese girl inviting me to attend a Valentine's Day Cruise, where there was going to be entertainment, live acts and buffet food. I explained I did not want to go on the Valentine's Days Cruise because of the Covid restrictions which were still in place. I

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was not under any impression the funding for this cruise was going to come out of my NDIS funding.

16. After receiving the Valentine's Day invitation February 2022, I received another invitation to attend a multicultural lunch where I had to buy food and they would take us back to a hotel, have a BBQ dinner and then the next day have breakfast. I did not go to this event as I was not well.

17. At some stage I had a conversation with Vida, suggesting I should change my plan manager. On 8 May 2022, Vida emailed me suggesting I should change my plan managers as my current plan managers are restricting my choice and control and were not paying for support's I am entitled to. Vida said that because your current plan managers were not paying the invoices it was not how it goes. Vida said that she knew how it worked as she worked for the NDIS.

18. In May 2022, Onboard Supports was recommended to me by Vida, and they are now my current plan managers. Onboard Supports emailed me on 26 May 2022 beginning services and CC'd in FFG staff member Janine Hall. I like Onboard Supports because they are prompt in paying my NDIS invoices.

19. On 13 September 2022, I sent an email titled 'termination of services' with FFG because I was not happy with the lack of services.

ANNEXURE: I NOW PRODUCE ML001: SENDING EMAIL STATING TERMINATING SERVICES WITH FFG.

20. After I sent the email on the 13 September 2022, I believe Yasmine rang me from a landline asking me to sign for renovations. I told her you're not supposed to contact me as I have terminated my services with FFG. After this conversation I never heard from anyone at FFG.

21. On 17 October 2022, Christine Bruckner an investigator from the NDIS contacted me to ask about my claims for the NDIS. We had a conversation over the phone about these claims.

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22. On 20 October 2022, Investigator Bruckner and I met, and she showed a list of claims which I can see there are claims for STA which I understand to be Short Term Accommodation, I can say I have never stayed away from my home. I can see claims listed there mentioning 'Access Community Social And Rec Activities', I have never received any of these services from FFG.

23. In our meeting on the 20 October 2022, Investigator Bruckner showed me claims for Counselling services and Psychology services, I can say I have never received these services as all my services for Psychology is claimed through my mental health care plan through Medicare.

24. In our meeting on the 20 October 2022, Investigator Bruckner showed me claims for 'House and/or Yard Maintenance', I can say I have never received these services from FFG or The Hive.

25. In our meeting on the 20 October 2022, Investigator Bruckner showed me claims for 'Community Social And Recreational Activities', I can say I have never received these services from FFG or The Hive.

26. This statement is true to the best of my knowledge and belief. I have made this statement knowing that, if it is tendered in evidence, I will be guilty of a crime if I have wilfully included in the statement anything that I know to be false or that I do not believe is true.

Signature _____
Marisha Lombard

Statement taken and signature witnessed by me about 8.19 am on 20 October 2022 at an address in Perth in Western Australia. \

Signature _____
Christine Bruckner – Fraud Investigator
Perth Western Australia

ML001

-------- Original message --------
From: custardncream1 <custardncream1@bigpond.com>
Date: 13/9/22 13:04 (GMT+08:00)
To: Vida Reid <vida@ffg.net.au>
Subject: termination of services

Hi Vida,

effective immediately I aould like to cease my services with the company. thankyou for the service. I please do not wish to be contacted by anyone from the company

regards
Marisha

Sent from my Galaxy